



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

2.c) Discuss the role of forensic anthropology in criminal investigation and disaster victim identification. (15 Marks)

Forensic anthropology is the branch of Applied anthropology which utilises the concept of biology, archeology, physical anthropology in the legal sphere.

Role in Criminal investigation

① Helps in identification of the victim and the accused.

↳ Through the serological methods

↳ Blood group Matching and testing.

↳ Saliva analysis → through the Molecular analysis.

② Helps in analysing the reason of death → any cut mark or healed masses.

③ In case of burned body, DNA Analysis or facial reconstruction is done.

④ It also traces the evolutionary history of family, ancestry, age, sex

Eg ⇒ Nithari Killings and Ankita Bhandari Case.

However, it must be Cross-checked with proper DNA-profiling and genomic data in our data base.

Role in Disaster victim identification

① It analyses the age, sex, height and skeletal feature of the victims.

② In the psychological front → it analyses, the mental trauma and blood clot in the brain, etc.

③ Focus on cultural analysis to understand the pain of the dead.
↳ if they had performed any ritual during the death, etc.

④ It further helps in augmenting our investigating data base.

[Eg] → Ahmedabad plane crash → DNA profiling through charred Bones, skeletal understanding of child, women, male, elderly, etc.
It was also used in wayanad landslide.

Hence, the forensic anthropology focus on cultural & biological aspect - giving the holistic picture.